

Self-Care Traumatic Episode Protocol (STEP)

Script



STEP was developed in consultation with Elan Shapiro and based on G-TAP
Original G-TAP Script by Elan Shapiro, STEP Script adapted by Judy Moench, 2020

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General Information



Script

This is the content and wording that we've found most helpful for delivering the protocol. Feel free to use your own style and personality to share it, but it's important to keep the main message clear and consistent.



Something To Remember

Here are some helpful tips for you to keep in mind. Do not read this information to participants.



What's Next

Information for the clinician. Do not read this information to participants.



Information for Online Sessions

Includes information you might need for running STEP online.

Script

Leaders, please have this script with you for all group meetings.

Read the text below to your participants (indicated by the  icon).

Session One



You have all had disturbing experiences recently, which may have affected you in different ways. The work that we will do here can help you feel calmer and stronger and regain your balance. My name is _____, and I will be leading the group. I'd also like you to meet (name other team members).



First, let's ensure that our technology is functioning smoothly. **Facilitators:** Can you see all the group members? **Participants:** If you experience internet issues and are disconnected during today's meeting, please take a moment to practice deep breathing and attempt to reconnect.



If you are unable to reconnect, one of our facilitators will reach out to you using the contact information you provided before the group.

Note for Facilitators:

- *Each facilitator should be assigned specific group members to contact if they leave the session or require additional support.*
- *Please ensure you have access to the 4 Elements audio and graphic materials. These resources can be sent to participants who experience connectivity issues to help them regulate and re-engage with the protocol if needed.*



We would like to take some time to have each of you introduce yourself and tell us something about yourself. We will be reviewing what has happened, but not quite yet. Let's first just get to know each other a bit. Maybe you want to share something you enjoy doing or a hobby that you have, just a little something about yourself. We will not be discussing what happened with the group, but we will be working through it individually. We will tell you more about that as we move forward. For now, let's meet the group members. I'll begin...



Introduce yourself and facilitate the introductions of the group members.



Thank you for introducing yourselves. Please give me a thumbs up when you have:

- printed documents on the table in front of you. Today you will need only one of the three pages (the one with STEP 1 on the bottom of the page).
- tissue
- water
- wristband or sticker or sticky note
- privacy
- anything else you will need while we work together



Let's watch the first video with a short introduction video explaining the process. This video is about eight minutes long.



Play the STEP Self-Care Introduction Video.



Next, is the Four Elements Video. The Four Elements is a self-care tool to reduce stress and anxiety. Verbal and written instructions guide the process while you focus on soothing music and bilateral beats. This video uses bilateral stimulation in the form of bilateral beats, so if you have a headset, you will notice the sound moving from one ear to the other. If you don't have a headset, that is fine, too; you can tap on your body on one side and then the other when you hear the beeps or tap at your own pace. If you are wearing a headset and the tapping is bothersome, please feel free to remove your headset and continue the bilateral tapping in another way. The next 2-minute video will show a few ways that we can do bilateral tapping. We are going to use bilateral tapping for the 4 Elements exercise. Let's watch the short video together.



Play the Bilateral Tapping Video.

Ensure you are in a comfortable location and away from other distractions or activities. You will be asked to write or draw on Step 1 (on the bottom of the sheet you have printed). I will be pressing pause and play throughout the video. I will also be asking you to give us a thumbs up when you are ready to continue. The facilitators (NAMES) will monitor everyone, and when they are ready to proceed, they will let me know verbally that everyone is ready to continue. Let's begin. This video is about 10 minutes long.



Play 4 Elements Video.



When the first pause appears in the video, please say:

When you're finished, please give us a thumbs up. The facilitators will let me know once everyone is ready to continue. Take as much time as you need.



Note: Group leaders may select to pause the video at other times during the protocol as needed for group members.



Please send us your 0 to 10 ratings BEFORE and AFTER the 4 Elements exercise.



Let the group members know how to send their scores. For example, they might use the private message function of the Zoom chat box.



Give me a thumbs up when you have sent your BEFORE and AFTER scores.



That brings us to an end for today.



We will be checking in with each of you to discuss the next steps with each group member individually to ensure that everyone gets what they need.



It was a pleasure being with you today. Thank you for your time.



I look forward to reviewing your feedback on the 4 Elements exercise for stress relief.



We will see each of you again soon.



Tell the group members how you plan to contact them between this session and the next.



Until then, take care. Bye for now.



This is the end of the first session. Prior to the next session, contact each group member individually to discuss the next steps. If any of the group members may be better suited for another type of intervention (given their score of above 7 following the 4 Elements video or another clinical reason), please gently guide them to continue to a more suitable treatment plan.

Session Two



It's good to see everyone today.



Just a quick reminder: as with last time, if you experience internet issues during the protocol, please take a moment to practice deep breathing and try to reconnect. If you've only missed a few seconds, you can jump back in and continue with us. If you've missed more than a few minutes, one of the facilitators will reach out to you. They will provide the 4 Elements audio and graphic for you to use on your own. They'll also arrange a time to catch up with you and continue the protocol at a later time.



Let's get started.



Please give me a thumbs up when you have:

- printed documents on the table in front of you. Today you will need all three sheets.
- tissue
- water
- wristband or sticker or sticky note. The reminder you used with the 4 Elements last time we met
- privacy
- anything else you will need while we work together



Also, this is a reminder that the video series uses bilateral stimulation in the form of bilateral beats. If you have a headset, you will notice sound moving from one ear to the other.



If you don't have a headset, that is fine, too; you can tap on your body on one side and then the other, as we did in the first session. If you are wearing a headset and find the beeps bothersome, please remove your headset and continue tapping on your body.



You have all had disturbing experiences recently, which may have affected you in different ways. This is a reminder that the work we will do here can help you feel calmer, stronger, and regain your balance. We will not discuss what happened in the group but rather process it individually, guided by the videos.



Before we begin, let's remind ourselves of the 4 Elements exercise.



Lead the group through the 4 Elements Exercise. A sample is included below:

Four Elements Exercise

- **Earth:** Place both feet on the ground and feel the support beneath you. Take a moment to “land” and be present. Look around and notice three things you haven’t seen before. What do you hear? What do you smell? You are here, now, as safe as you can be in this moment.
- **Air:** Focus on your breathing. Inhale through your nose for 4 seconds, hold for 2, and exhale for 4 seconds. Repeat for five or six slow, deep breaths. Let your breathing bring you back to your center.
- **Water:** Notice your mouth—is it dry or wet? Imagine the taste of a lemon and create more saliva. Saliva is a sign of relaxation. Take a moment to feel your focus and control returning.
- **Fire or Light:** Picture a calm, safe place—a person, pet, or memory that soothes you. Feel the sensations it brings to your body. Name this place and strengthen the connection with butterfly hugs or bilateral tapping.



Remember, you can repeat the exercise several times daily. Use a reminder, like a wristband or sticker, to help. With practice, you’ll more easily access a sense of calm when needed.



Now, just like last time, I will be pressing pause and play through the video series. I will also ask you to give us a thumbs up when you are ready to continue. The facilitator(s) will monitor everyone to see when they are ready to proceed and will let me know verbally that we are ready to continue.



We are going to take some time to review and process what has happened to help you feel calmer and stronger. Let’s begin...



Play Protocol Sheet Video.

What are you taking with you from the work that you have done today? We would like to hear your thoughts.



Lead a short discussion.



Reminder: We will not be discussing the disturbing events but rather any take home messages or learning that may have come up for them.



Let's do the container activity together now.



Play the Container Video.



Let's take 10 minutes now before we end to do the 4 Elements exercises once more. Remember, you can take these activities with you and do them whenever you want to lower your stress level. Let's watch the last video together now.



Play the 4 Elements Video.



We would like you to take a moment after we end to open the 'feedback form' that was sent to you and take a couple of minutes to complete it. We would like to receive your 0 to 10 ratings from your work today. If you are interested in sharing your worksheets with the group leader, please take a picture of them and send them via email.



Thank you for sharing. It has been a pleasure working with you today! Thank you for using STEP Together. You will receive your post-test measures in one week. We will be checking in with you in the next couple of days. I want to thank you for the opportunity to do this protocol with you. We will look forward to seeing you again.



This is the end of the group.

After the STEP Together Group

After the group, please remember to:

1. **Collect Pre-and-Post-Data Forms:** Those eligible for the STEP Together group will complete the Pre-and-Post-Data forms using the link below. These measures will need to be completed by the group participants *before* the intervention group and again one week *after* the group. Please send the link via email to each group member one week after the group and ensure they are completed. This information can be used to assist in treatment planning.

a.  [Pre-and-Post-Test Data](#)

2. **Collect the Feedback Form:** Send participants the link to complete the feedback form. There are two components to the feedback form. The first is a record of their SUDs throughout the protocol sheet for your records and to inform follow-up discussions with your clients. The second portion of the feedback form is anonymous and allows participants to provide feedback to help us develop and improve the protocol. Participants will be asked to complete the feedback form at the end of the group.

a.   The [Feedback Form](#) is sent in email **TOGETHER-6: Processing Meeting** (See STEP Together Sample Email document on Kajabi).

3. **Participant Checklist Form:** Finish the Participant Checklist Form for each group member.

a.  See module “Before the Group” on Kajabi

4. **Follow-up:** Check in with your clients to see how the process was for them and discuss the next steps moving forward.

a.  See Kajabi for the STEP Together Sample Email document (email **TOGETHER-7: Follow-Up**).

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